Natural Heritage

The geology of the area has evidently influenced the construction and architecture of the monument. The tabular cleavage of the rocks could easily produce brick like stones without need for using technologically advanced tools to shape the bricks.

There are different species of plants that are found in the area. The common species are: ***Colophospermum mopane*** (Mophane), ***Boscia foetida*** (Smelly shepherd's tree / stink bush, Mopipi), Ximenia americana (small sour plum / blue sour plum, Morotologana / moretologa wa podi), ***Acacia nigrescens*** (Knob thorn, Mokoba / Molalakgaka), ***Steganotaenia araliacea*** (Carrot tree, Modumela / Morobolo / Morukutshwane).

Some of the species that are not common include the following family: Apocynaceae; This plant is Orbea (Seboka), which is used for medicinal purposes. The plant is found within the fenced area especially among bush thickets and *Gonambrassia belina*; The invertebrate zoology of Majojo is very much influenced by the vegetation, probably because most insects are dependent on the plants for food at the larva stage. The mophane moth caterpillar (***Gonimbrassia belina***) is the most abundant during the season when the mophane trees have sufficient fresh foliage for the caterpillars to feed on.

Many other species of ***Lepidoptera*** occurring in the area include Junonia cebrene, ***J. oenone, Charaxes***, and over 3 species of ***Colotis***. Other insects that are present include Cicadas, Beetles, Mantis, Grasshoppers, Bugs and Spiders. The vertebrates occuring in the area include snakes (puff adder), lizards, skinks and Kudu.

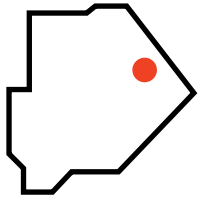
Some Rules

Majojo is National Monument administered by the Botswana National Museum and protected by the revised Monuments and Relics Act (2001). Adherence to some basic guidelines will make your visit worthwhile and ensure the continued protection of a part of Botswana's unique heritage:

- Use the designated parking lot and report to the Custodians' office to complete the visitors' book.
- Please do not interfere with the stone walls or any other feature.
- Do not remove any artifacts.
- Please respect the local culture and leave objects at the site in place.
- Cooperate with the Custodians.
- Take all your litter away with you.

PLEASE NOTE:
Researchers and commercial photographers, contact the National Museum for more information.





Designation:
Cultural
Area: approx. 3km²
Adoption priorities:
visitor interpretation centre,
field assistants, signage, trails

For further information, contact:
The Archaeology Division, Botswana National Museum
Private Bag 00114 Gaborone, Botswana
Phone: +267 3974616 Fax: +267 3911186 / 3902797

MAJOJO
hill

BOTSWANA national museum

ADOPT A MONUMENT
GIVING LIFE TO BOTSWANA'S HERITAGE SITES

MJ201511

Cultural Heritage Site

MAJOJO HILL

The Majojo monument is situated in the Central District, just 5 kilometres South from Serule along the Gaborone – Francistown highway, on the right before Serule river. It is a small hill, spreading to the west, at the altitude of 995 metres, with the grid reference of 21° 58′ 39″ S, 27° 17′ 41″ E. The monument is situated within a larger hardveld vegetation area, characterised by the following three tree species; ***Colophospermum mopane*** (Mophane), ***Acacia nigrescens*** (knobthorn tree, mokoba) and ***Burkea Africana*** (wild srynga, monato)









Cultural Heritage

This is one of 105 known Zimbabwe Tradition elite sites in eastern Botswana, stretching from Nkange and the Sowa Pan to the Limpopo River. More than 550 such stonewalled ruins are known to exist in the sub-region.

Majojo Ruin on the east end of Majojo Hill was a ‘muzinda’, the residence of a chief or ‘she’ some time between 1,300 and 1,650 A.D. The walls that mark the palace on the south and east side have been built in the incorporated within a large state that extended over the High Plateau of Zimbabwe and into the Northern Province of South Africa. The architecture at Majojo site is characteristic of all the Zimbabwe and Butua States, where stones were quarried from rocks and outcrops by heating with fire and then quickly cooling them with water, breaking off stones with relatively straight sides and shaping them as bricks. The walls consist of a number of distinct sections, suggesting that they were built in stages and not in one building episode.

The house that was located in front of the main entrance was the likely location of the ‘dale’, where the Chief judged court cases and where the men assembled to discuss politics and trade and cattle, similar to the ‘kgotla’ found today in every village in Botswana.

The ruin is sacred to local people today, as it is a tangible connection with their ancestors. Religious healing ceremonies are on occasion carried out here and offerings brought for the ancestors. You may find clay pots or gourds placed in the enclosure, sometimes you may find candles or some coins.